CORE ITEM UPDATE · INDIA

# Core Item Update: Women's suits and kurtas 2026–28

Kurta sets are the backbone of Indian womenswear.

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# Overview

Kurta sets are the backbone of Indian womenswear. Fit-and-flare Anarkalis hold steady at their peak, embroidered co-ord sets are rising fast, and festive kaftan kurtas grow through 2027. Angrakha wrap kurtas are the emerging shape to watch.

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|---|---|---|---|
| INVEST | TEST | MAINTAIN | REDUCE |

Invest: rising now. Test: emerging. Maintain: at its peak. Reduce: fading.

# The details

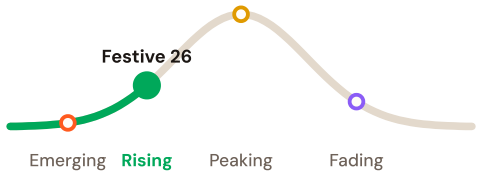
Each detail with its status for Festive 26, its trend curve and what it does next.



INVEST RISING

## Embroidered kurta co-ord sets

Matching kurta and trousers with coordinated embroidery. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.




Festive 26 Rising
Summer 27 Peaking
Festive 27 Peaking
Summer 28
Festive 28



INVEST RISING

## Festive kaftan kurtas

Kaftans with Indian prints and embroidery, worn to festive events. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.




Festive 26 Rising
Summer 27 Rising
Festive 27 Peaking
Summer 28 Peaking
Festive 28 Fading



INVEST RISING

## Kalidar-cut kurtas

Kurtas built from many flared panels (kalis) for swing without heavy gathers; seen in Max Fashion Festive 2026. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



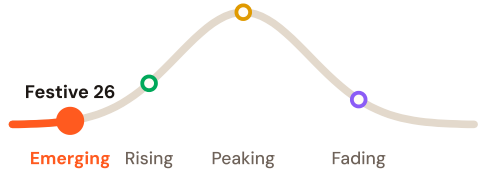

Festive 26 Rising
Summer 27 Rising
Festive 27 Peaking



TEST EMERGING

## Angrakha wrap kurtas

Overlapping wrap fronts tied at the side. Early signal. Trial in small drops and premium lines.




Festive 26 Emerging
Summer 27 Rising
Festive 27 Rising
Summer 28 Peaking
Festive 28 Peaking

Peaking

Fading

Summer 28
Peaking

Festive 28
Peaking



MAINTAIN PEAKING

## Fit-and-flare Anarkalis

Flattering, comfortable Anarkalis that suit most occasions. At its height. Keep in core ranges without over-buying.




| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Peaking | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Peaking | |



MAINTAIN PEAKING

## Straight kurtas with palazzos

Straight-cut suits with wide palazzos for comfort. At its height. Keep in core ranges without over-buying.




| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Peaking | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Fading |
| Summer 28 | Festive 28 | |

| | |
|---|---|
| Fading | – |

## How to update your women's suits and kurtas range

- Keep Anarkalis in core ranges in jewel tones.
- Invest in embroidered kurta co-ords with placement work at the neckline.
- Test angrakha wraps with ties instead of buttons.
- Reduce straight kurtas with palazzos after Summer 27.

## What to check in women's suits and kurtas development

- **Length:** short, hip, knee and ankle lengths serve different customers.
- **Neck and sleeve:** keep a few signature necklines and update with details such as yokes and placket trims.
- **Sets:** define what is included: kurta, bottom and dupatta.
- **Sizing:** include bust, waist and hip measurements and the length for each size.

## Fabric guide

Choose fabric by occasion, climate and price point. The same design often needs two fabric options: a premium version and a value or summer version.

- Cotton, mulmul and cambric for summer
- Chanderi and cotton-silk for festive
- Rayon and viscose for value ranges
- Linen blends for premium casual

## The global view

Indian women's suits and kurtas sell well beyond India, to South Asian communities in the UK, North America, the Gulf, Southeast Asia and Australia, and increasingly to customers discovering Indian craft. For international customers, provide clear size conversions, care guidance and styling ideas for local events.

## Common questions

**Which kurta lengths sell best?** It varies by region and age; many brands carry knee to calf lengths as core and test short kurtas for younger customers.

**Are co-ord sets replacing suits?** They sit alongside suits, especially for daily and work wear.

See every women's suits and kurtas detail with design notes and downloadable cards in the India Forecast 2026–28.

Statuses are Forecut's forecast for India: Festive 26 (Oct 2026 – Feb 2027), Summer 27 (Mar – Jul 2027), Festive 27 (Aug – Dec 2027), and long-range outlooks for Summer 28 (Mar – Jul 2028) and Festive 28 (Aug – Dec 2028). Sources: India trends summarise public coverage of Lakmé Fashion Week x FDCI 2026 (Harper's Bazaar India, Free Press Journal), Aza Fashions festive and ethnic trend guides, Lashkaraa colour and silhouette trends 2026, Pearl Academy Gen Z trend reports, Gully Labs, Global Indian (Prada SS26 Kolhapuri-inspired sandals) and Outlook Business (Gen Z and e-retail).